

NCL Bliss — Alaska Solo Group

July 11–18, 2026 · Kristie McClung Escoe, host

Ship: Norwegian Bliss · Sailing from: Pier 66, Seattle · Cabin: _____

A condensed Voyage Pack from [In the Wake](#) — the essentials in three pages. The full pack covers cabins, packing, budget, ship orientation, ports in depth, and first-cruise notes.

Day by day

#	Date	Port	Hours ashore	Tender	The one thing
1	Sat Jul 11	Seattle — embarkation	board 11:30 AM – 3:00 PM; depart 4 PM	—	All-aboard 2 PM. Kristie at Sea View Bar, Deck 17 for sailaway.
2	Sun Jul 12	Inside Passage (sea day)	—	—	Settling-in day. Teppanyaki 5:00 PM — group dinner.
3	Mon Jul 13	Sitka	10:00 AM – 6:00 PM	yes	Sitka National Historical Park totem trail (free, 30-min walk) or sea-otter boat tour (~\$210).
4	Tue Jul 14	Juneau + Dawes Glacier	Juneau 6:30 AM – 1:30 PM; Dawes ~3:00–7:00 PM scenic-cruising	no	Mendenhall via M&M Tours (\$79, 3 hrs). Cagney’s 5:30 PM conflicts with glacier face — choose.
5	Wed Jul 15	Icy Strait Point	mid-morning – evening	yes	World’s Largest ZipRider (\$199) or whale-watching. Le Bistro 5:45 PM — group dinner.
6	Thu Jul 16	Ketchikan / Ward Cove	6:00 AM – 1:15 PM	no, but Ward Cove + NCL shuttle (20–30 min to downtown)	Creek Street + Totem Heritage Center. Tight day; pick one focus.
7	Fri Jul 17	Victoria, BC	8:00 PM – 11:59 PM	no, Ogden Point + shuttle	Inner Harbour walk at night. Passport required.
8	Sat Jul 18	Seattle — debarkation	off by 10:00 AM	—	Port Valet if eligible (see page 2).

Three group specialty dinners are pre-booked with Kristie: Teppanyaki (Day 2), Cagney’s (Day 4 — glacier conflict), Le Bistro (Day 5). The 3-meal NCL Specialty Dining Package covers all three if you’re attending each.

Mandatory muster drill is the afternoon of Day 1 — partly app-based (watch safety video in the NCL app before sailaway) plus an in-person check-in at your assigned station.

Currency aboard: USD. **Sea days vs. port days:** 2 sea-day-style segments (Day 2 full sea day; Day 4 afternoon scenic-cruising). 5 days ashore.

Verify your specific day order in the NCL app — the published sequence sometimes shifts between sailings.

Getting to the ship — and getting home

Arrival: Friday optional, Saturday required

Friday, July 10 — optional “Get Acquainted” dinner. Kristie hosts an 8:30 PM happy-hour gathering at **Currant Bistro** inside the **Sound Hotel Seattle Belltown** (2120 4th Ave). Casual; appetizers and drinks à la carte. Confirm attendance with Kristie if you want a seat saved.

Where to stay Friday night. Sound Hotel Belltown is convenient (you’re already there for dinner). Anywhere in Belltown, Downtown, or near Pike Place puts you within walking distance of Pier 66.

Saturday, July 11 — embarkation.

- **Terminal: Bell Street Cruise Terminal at Pier 66**, 2225 Alaskan Way, Seattle. *Different terminal from Pier 91 used by RCL/Princess/HAL.*
- **Sea-Tac (SEA) → Pier 66:** Uber/Lyft 30–40 min, \$40–60.
- **If driving:** Bell Street Pier garage directly across from the terminal, ~\$33/day, max vehicle height 6’6”, reservable in advance.
- **Early luggage drop-off: 8:00 AM** at the terminal.
- **Embark window:** 11:30 AM – 3:00 PM. **All-aboard 2:00 PM.** Ship departs ~4:00 PM.
- **Saturday morning options after bag drop:** Pike Place Market (quietest before 9 AM); Biscuit Bitch Belltown breakfast; waterfront walk; back to terminal by 2 PM.

Day 8 debark and the trip home

- **6:30 AM:** Bags must be in the hall the night before — NCL color-codes by tag.
- **7:00 – 9:30 AM:** Walk-off in waves. **Self-disembarkation** (carry all bags off) starts ~7:00 AM, fastest if you have a flight to catch.
- **10:00 AM (latest):** All passengers off.

Port Valet — use it. The Port of Seattle’s free service transfers your checked bag from the ship directly to your final-destination airline check-in. Walk off Bliss with only your carry-on; bag meets you in baggage claim at home. Available for most major airlines on most departure days; sign-up sheet distributed onboard mid-cruise (typically Day 4 or 5 — watch the *Freestyle Daily*). **The single most useful piece of post-cruise logistics in Seattle.**

Bag storage (if Port Valet didn’t fit your routing): Pier 66 Crew Center, **\$6/bag/day, pickup by 3 PM.**

Getting to SEA without an Uber — Pier 66 is the pack where this actually works. From Pier 66, walk 8 minutes to **Westlake Station** and catch the **Link light rail** directly to SEA: **\$3.50, ~40 minutes, no transfer.** The cheapest, most reliable airport route from any Seattle cruise pier. Trains run every 8 min.

Uber/Lyft from Pier 66 to SEA: \$40–60, 25–35 minutes.

Killing 4–6 hours before an evening flight. Pier 66 is downtown — most of central Seattle is walkable from the terminal:

- **Pike Place Market** — 10-min walk, uphill on the return.
- **Olympic Sculpture Park** — 5-min walk north along the waterfront. Free.
- **Seattle Aquarium** — 5-min walk south, \$40, ~90 min.
- **Space Needle + Chihuly Garden** — 15-min walk or 5-min Uber to Seattle Center; ~90 min combined visit.

Airport-arrival timing.

Flight	Leave Pier 66 by
Domestic, after 5 PM	2:00 PM (Link) or 2:30 PM (Uber)
International, after 7 PM	3:00 PM

SEA TSA lines run 30–60 min during Saturday afternoon cruise debark.

Emergency contacts — handoff card

Copy this, fill in your specifics, and share with one trusted person ashore before you sail.

FAMILY HANDOFF — IN THE WAKE VOYAGE PACK

CRUISER: _____
CABIN: _____
SHIP: Norwegian Bliss
LINE: Norwegian Cruise Line (NCL)
SAILING: July 11 – 18, 2026
FROM: Pier 66, Bell Street Cruise Terminal,
Seattle, WA, USA
ITINERARY: Seattle → Inside Passage → Sitka →
Juneau → Dawes Glacier → Icy Strait Point →
Ketchikan → Victoria BC → Seattle
GROUP HOST: Kristie McClung Escoe
(group contact: ask Kristie)

EMERGENCY (24/7) – NCL Care Team:
+1 (305) 436-4000 (US/Canada)
+1 (866) 234-0292 (toll-free US)

SHIP-TO-SHORE: In emergency, NCL Care Team relays to ship.

NEAREST EMBASSY/CONSULATE BY PORT:
Seattle, WA – US domestic; call 911
Sitka, AK – US domestic; call 911
Juneau, AK – US domestic; call 911 or
US Coast Guard Juneau: +1 (907) 463-2980
Icy Strait Pt – US domestic; call 911
Ketchikan, AK – US domestic; call 911
Victoria, BC – US Consulate Vancouver: +1 (604) 685-4311
Canada emergency: 911

CRUISER MEDICAL:
Allergies: _____
Medications: _____
Conditions: _____
Insurance: _____ policy: _____

MOST RECENT KNOWN POSITION:
Track at: /tools/ship-tracker.html
or marinetraffic.com (search "Norwegian Bliss")

What an at-home contact actually does

If they haven't heard from you for 36+ hours and they're worried:

1. **Don't panic.** Cruise Wi-Fi is unreliable; silence usually means signal, not emergency.
2. **Call the NCL Care Team** at the number above. NCL will confirm you boarded and can relay messages to the ship.
3. **Reach Kristie** if you shared her contact info — she's your in-person on the ship.
4. **If NCL confirms an incident:** US Coast Guard for Alaska waters; US Consulate Vancouver for Victoria; NCL's on-board medical team for medical issues.

What to pack for emergencies

- Printed list of medications, allergies, and emergency contacts (in your cabin nightstand).
- Photocopy of passport, separate from the passport itself.
- Travel insurance policy number, printed.
- This handoff card, in your phone's notes app and shared with one trusted person ashore.

The full Voyage Pack — cabin guide, deck-by-deck ship orientation, packing list calibrated for Alaska in July, budget breakdown, port pages in depth, group rhythm with Kristie, solo-cruising notes, and first-cruise orientation — is available as the unabridged companion document. This condensed version is for travelers who want only the essentials in printable form. Soli Deo Gloria.